

Ch. 11 — P02 (A) Antithetic Variates

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The antithetic variates method pairs each run with a “mirror” run using $1 - U$ in place of U for each uniform deviate. For a monotone increasing estimator $g(U)$, this induces negative correlation between paired runs and reduces variance:

$$\text{Var}\left(\frac{g(U) + g(1 - U)}{2}\right) = \frac{\text{Var}[g(U)] + \text{Cov}[g(U), g(1 - U)]}{2}$$

Tasks

1. **Analytical example:** Let $U \sim \text{Uniform}(0, 1)$ and $g(U) = U^2$. Compute:

- (a) $E[g(U)] = E[U^2]$
- (b) $\text{Var}[g(U)]$
- (c) $\text{Cov}[g(U), g(1 - U)]$
- (d) $\text{Var}[(g(U) + g(1 - U))/2]$

What is the variance reduction ratio compared to using n independent runs?

2. **Exponential service times:** For an M/M/1 queue, service times use the inverse CDF: $S = -\frac{1}{\mu} \ln(U)$. Show that $S' = -\frac{1}{\mu} \ln(1 - U)$ is also $\text{Exponential}(\mu)$. Does this guarantee negative correlation between $W_q(S)$ and $W_q(S')$? Under what conditions on the queueing model is the answer yes?

3. **Coding:** Implement an M/M/1 simulation ($\lambda = 0.7$, $\mu = 1.0$, 1000 customers) that:

- (a) Runs $n = 20$ independent replications
- (b) Runs $n = 10$ antithetic pairs (20 runs total, paired)

Report the standard error of $\hat{W}_q$ under each approach. Compute the variance reduction ratio.

4. **Limitation:** Antithetic variates require g to be monotone in the input uniforms to guarantee a variance reduction. Describe a queueing scenario where this monotonicity breaks down. (*Hint: consider priority queues or finite buffers.*)